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Building a Criminal Justice Data Archive for Australia

Toby Burrows and Leanne den Hartog

Australian Criminal Justice Data Archive

Summary

- Collaboration between the Australian Data Archive (ADA) and the National Criminal Justice Research Data Network (NCJRDN)
- An integral part of ADA as well as a separate “portal”
- Covers state and federal government agency data as well as survey data and research results
- Modelled on the National Archive of Criminal Justice Data (ICPSR and partners)
- A work in progress!

National Criminal Justice Research Data Network

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The National Criminal Justice Research Data Network aims to facilitate access to data by establishing a web based service through which researchers can obtain information about and access to criminal justice research datasets and data analysis tools.

www.ncjrdn.org.au

crime RESEARCH centre

NCJRDN Stakeholders

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- Australian Institute of Criminology (Canberra)
- UWA Crime Research Centre
- New South Wales Bureau of Crime Statistics and Research (BOCSAR)
- Northern Territory Dept. of Justice
- Tasmania Dept. of Justice
- Research groups at Melbourne University and Griffith University (QLD)
- Australian National Data Service (ANDS)
- Australian Research Collaboration Service (ARCS)

NCJRDN Rationale

- There is a growing demand for quantitative criminal justice research data
- Researchers do not have equal or easy rights to access criminal justice data
- There is little information or understanding about criminal justice data
- Limited scope for cross-jurisdictional collaboration

NCJRDN Objectives

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- ‘Pool’ currently available administrative datasets in a ‘one stop shop’
- Encourage data custodians to release data through ‘controlled’ data access
- Streamline data access mechanisms
- ‘Showcase’ data analysis tools

NCJRDN Progress

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Data Availability Survey

- Sent to all Australian criminal justice agencies
- Information on 32 datasets from 10 agencies in 5 jurisdictions
- New South Wales, Queensland, Western Australia, Victoria

Preferred Data Access Model

- ASSDA – sub-archive within new ADA structure

Tools Demonstration/Analysis

NCJRDN Issues Around Data

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Negotiating data access

"Yes, perhaps, but we don't have to"

"What's in it for us?"

What datasets do researchers actually want?

NCJRDN Datasets

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- WA Police data (1990-2006): Apprehension counts; Distinct persons; Events
- NSW Police data (1995-2009): Incidents; Persons of interest; Victims
- Victorian Department of Justice (test data – one year only): Children's Court; Higher courts; Family violence; Magistrate's Court
- ADA already holds: NSW Criminal Courts and Lower Courts data (1990-2005); NSW Recorded Crime data (1996-2005); numerous surveys relating to crime, law enforcement, legal issues, and policing

Role of the Australian Data Archive (ADA)

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- Existing platform for data archiving and delivery
- Nesstar analytical tools + download facility
- Existing expertise – data archivists especially
- Curation, metadata, verification services
- Managing access – user registration; unrestricted and restricted data
- Includes research datasets and surveys – not just government agency statistics
- Sub-archives / portals – new ADA Web site – the NACJD model

New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 1997-2000: File hc01
New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 1997-2000: File hc02
New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 2003: Higher courts
New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 2004: Higher Courts
New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 2005: Higher Courts
Metadata
Study Description
Data Files Description
au.edu.anu.assda.ddi.01026-hc05
Variable Description
Bookmarks
New South Wales Criminal Courts Data Annual Collection: Lower Courts
New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 1990: Local Courts
New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 1991: Local Courts
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New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 2004: Lower Courts
New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 2005: Lower Courts
New South Wales Recorded Crime Data: Incidents
New South Wales Recorded Crime Data 1996-2002: File inc96
New South Wales Recorded Crime Data 1996-2002:

DESCRIPTION | TABULATION | ANALYSIS

Dataset: New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 2005: Higher Courts

Full Title
New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 2005: Higher Courts

Identification Number
au.edu.anu.assda.ddi.01026-hc05

Authoring Entity
- NSW Bureau of Crime Statistics and Research Affiliation: NSW Attorney General's Department

Copyright
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Date of Production
2010-01-20

Data Distributor
- Australian Social Science Data Archive Abbreviation: ASSDA
  Affiliation: The Australian National University

Depositor
- NSW Bureau of Crime Statistics and Research, NSW Attorney General's Department

Date of Deposit
2007-09-12

Series Name
New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection

Version
Version 1
Date: 2010-01-20

Version Responsibility Statement
Australian Social Science Data Archive

Bibliographic Citation
NSW Bureau of Crime Statistics and Research. New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 2005: Higher Courts. [computer file]. Canberra: Australian

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Bibliographic Citation

NSW Bureau of Crime Statistics and Research, New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 2005: Higher Courts, [computer file]. Canberra: Australian Social Science Data Archive, The Australian National University, 2010.

List of Keywords

- Courts
- Crime
- Criminals
- Law
- Prosecution
- Sentencing

Topic Classification

- Australian studies
- Law, Crime, Courts
- Crime and law enforcement

Abstract

The NSW Criminal Courts Data Collection is an annually compiled record of court data for both Local and Higher (District and Supreme) Courts in the state of NSW. This study follows the New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 1990 - 1996. There is a change in the structure of the recorded court data for the Local Courts from previous years.

Local Court data is now penalty based and represents cases which were finalised in the NSW Local Courts in the year of the collection. In this set, one record is allocated to each penalty, and so more than one record may exist for a single person. Variables in this set include offence classification, both at a specific level of coding and at various levels of broader grouping, drug related variables, the plea of the defendant for each offence, and the fine and/or penalty durations for each of the defendant's offences.

Background variables include sex, date of birth, courthouse in which the case appeared and the dates of hearings and offences.

Higher Court data is penalty based and represents cases which were finalised in the NSW District and Supreme Courts in the year of the collection. In this set, one record is allocated to each penalty, and so more than one record may exist for a single person. The variables here included offence, outcome, penalty variables including type and duration of penalty, drug related variables, plea, and bail status of the accused.

Background variables include sex, date and country of birth, Local Court from which the case was committed, date of committal to Higher Court, education, employment status and occupation type, marital status, outcome and sentencing dates.

This particular file reflects data collected from Higher courts in 2005.

Time Period Covered

Start: 2005-01-01 End: 2005-12-31

Country

- Australia

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Sampling Procedure

- No sampling (total universe)

Mode of Data Collection

Compilation or synthesis of existing material

Class of the Study

Level 2

Confidentiality declaration

A copy of the User Undertaking Form (http://nesstar.assda.edu.au/ASSDAData/forms/ASSDA.FORM.CRIMCOURT.pdf) must be signed before the data can be accessed

Special Permissions

The depositor has requested that the user apply for permission to access these data. Please complete the Application to Access Restricted Data Form (http://nesstar.assda.edu.au/webview/ASSDAData/forms/ASSDA.FORM.ACCESSB.pdf) and return it to ASSDA who will contact the depositor on your behalf.

Citation Requirement

All manuscripts based in whole or in part on these data should:

(i) identify the data and original investigators by using the recommended bibliographic reference to the data file;

(ii) acknowledge the Australian Social Science Data Archive and, where the data are made available through the Australian Social Science Data Archive by another archive, acknowledge that archive;

(iii) declare that those who carried out the original analysis and collection of the data bear no responsibility for the further analysis or interpretation of them.

Deposit Requirement

In order to assemble essential information about archival resources and to facilitate the exchange of information about users' research activities, individuals are required to email ASSDA (assda@anu.edu.au) with the bibliographic details and, where available, online links to any published work (including journal articles, books or book chapters, conference presentations, theses or any other publications or outputs) based wholly or in part on the material.

Disclaimer

Use of the material is solely at the user's risk. The depositor, The Australian National University and the Australian Social Science Data Archive shall not be held responsible for the accuracy and completeness of the material supplied.

Related Materials

Online Codebook

Higher Courts Data Dictionary

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New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 2004: Lower Courts
New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data

DESCRIPTION TABULATION ANALYSIS

Dataset: New South Wales Criminal Courts Annual Data Collection, 2005: Higher Courts

...

Comment

A default section, which collects together variables with no specified group

- Law Part code
- ASOC
- country of birth - accused
- country of birth - mother
- country of birth - father
- drug unit
- accused number
- drug type code
- grouped bail status of the accused
- grouped outcome for person
- occupation code
- principal offence indicator
- flag for selecting cases
- flag for selecting charges
- flag for selecting persons
- ranked bail status of the accused
- committal year
- monetary amt for penalty(if applicable)
- duration:arrest to commital (days)
- duration:commital to outcome (days)
- duration:outcome to sentence (days)
- Age of accussed at time of arrest
- Aust. Standard Offence Class.
- first level ASOC
- second level ASOC
- length of total period (months)
- market value
- reference number
- penalty for principal offence
- offence counter for person
- penalty counter for offence
- person identification number
- occupation description
- Registry where cases were registered
- current bail status of the accused
- type of case (trial/sentence/appeal)
- highest educational level
- employment status of individual
- legal aid used
- marital status

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Issues Arising

- Complexity of the Australian criminal justice system
- High profile and misuse of criminal justice statistics
- Reluctance of data custodians to release data
- Lack of documentation about datasets
- Sustainability and continuity of NCJRDN

Australian correctional agencies and facilities

Each state/territory page contains a list of correctional facilities with information on classification/security, gender, capacity, function and ownership.

Note: The details on these pages have been compiled from publicly available information for convenience. The Australian Institute of Criminology will review this information periodically but cannot guarantee its accuracy or completeness.

Public sector authorities

- ACT Corrective Services (Australian Capital Territory)
- Corrective Services NSW (New South Wales)
- Department of Justice : Correctional Services (Northern Territory)
- Queensland Corrective Services (Queensland)
- Department of Justice : Correctional Services (South Australia)
- Tasmania Department of Justice : Corrective Services (Tasmania)
- Corrections Victoria (Victoria)
- Department of Corrective Services (Western Australia)
- Office of the Inspector of Custodial Services (Western Australia)

Private sector operators

- GEO Group Australia Pty Ltd
- GSL Custodial Services Pty Ltd
- Management and Training Corporation
- Australian Integrated Management Services Corporation

Contents

- Australian Capital Territory correctional facilities
- New South Wales correctional facilities
- Northern Territory correctional facilities
- Queensland correctional facilities
- South Australian correctional facilities

Sub categories

- Australian Capital Territory correctional facilities
- New South Wales correctional facilities
- Northern Territory correctional facilities
- Queensland correctional facilities
- South Australian correctional facilities
- Tasmanian correctional facilities
- Victorian correctional facilities
- Western Australian correctional facilities
- Corrections links
- Imprisonment and detention

AIC work

- Publications
- Conferences
- Statistics

Courts

Judicial organisations

- Australian Institute of Judicial Administration
- Judical College of Australia
- Judical Commission of New South Wales
- Judicial Conference of Australia
- National Judicial College of Australia

Prosecution agencies

- Commonwealth
- Australian Capital Territory
- New South Wales
- Northern Territory
- Queensland
- South Australia
- Tasmania
- Victoria
- Western Australia

Contents

- Federal courts
- Juvenile court system
- Other research
- Sentencing
- Specialist courts
- State and territory courts
- Trials

Recent publications

Done

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Issues Arising

- Complexity of the Australian criminal justice system
- High media profile and misuse of criminal justice statistics
- Reluctance of data custodians to release data
- Lack of documentation about datasets
- Sustainability and continuity of NCJRDN

Welcome to BigFooty! Will you join over 95,000 footy fans today?

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Australian Football
My Footy
AFL Team Boards
More Footy
Footy Games
The Other Footballs
More Sports
Education
Not Footy Related
Customer Service

hbf essentials

2 May 2011, 09:59 #1

RisingPhoenix
BigFooty Member

West Coast
NAFC SFFC
Join Date: Dec 2010
Location: Down South

Is Perth the most violent capital city in Australia?

http://au.news.yahoo.com/thewest/a/-...rvive-assault/

Another big weekend in 'boomtown' Perth

Is Perth the most violent capital city in Australia? Sure, it isnt the size of Melbourne or Sydney who with there higher polulations will have a higher number of incidences, but for sheer likelihood of going for a night out on the town and ending up getting killed you would have to think Perth is a real contender.

Or is it just Perth's tabloid media with its 'one punch' obsession and taste for all things sensational that has cultivated this image?

Many of you on here will already know my background, so im not going to frame this discussion within that - all people who have lived in Perth have experiences and stories to share on this topic, regardless of what past professions they have held.

I have my own theories and views, but im interested to hear the views of others on what (Besides grog), is driving this violence? Is it poor urban planning and policies? Is it drinking laws? Is it Perth's culture, and if so what is Perth's 'culture'? What is the true percentage of unprovoked violent behaviour commited by Aboriginals against non Aboriginals? Is the 'boom' playing a part?

Im curious to hear everyone's views.

Quote

NSW Recorded Crime Statistics 2010 – Media release

Eight LGAs had upward trends for two of the 17 major offences. They were:

Blacktown LGA: *Steal from motor vehicle* and *steal from dwelling*

Griffith LGA: *Break and enter dwelling* and *steal from motor vehicle*

Gunnedah LGA*: *Steal from motor vehicle *and* ***malicious damage to property***

Lachlan LGA: *Break and enter dwelling* and *break and enter non-dwelling*

Maitland LGA: *Break and enter dwelling* and *steal from retail store*

Port Macquarie-Hastings LGA: *Break and enter dwelling* and *steal from retail store*

Wellington LGA: *Break and enter dwelling* and *steal from motor vehicle*

Wollongong LGA: *Break and enter dwelling* and *break and enter non-dwelling*

Among the expanded list of 62 offences for the 24 months to December 2010, 12 showed an upward trend. They were as follows: *Possession and/or use of cocaine* (up 23.3%), *Possession and/or use of cannabis* (up 36.9%), *Possession and/or use of amphetamines* (up 54.5%), *Possession and/or use of other drugs* (up 42.3%), *Dealing, trafficking in cannabis* (up 33.4%), *Dealing, trafficking in amphetamines* (up 63.2%), *Dealing, trafficking in other drugs* (up 50.6%), *Other drug offences* (up 12.2%), *Prostitution offences* (up 56.3%), *Breach bail conditions* (up 7.4%), *Fail to appear* (up 20.1%) and *Transport regulatory offences* (up 26.5%).

Gunnedah – Koala Capital of the World

Crime figures put shire in spotlight

April 19, 2011 from *Namoi Valley Independent*

"Figures released today by the NSW Bureau of Crime Statistics and Research show that there has been an upward trend in the number of stealing from motor vehicle offences and malicious damage incidents in Gunnedah in the 24 months to December, 2010.

The broad picture among the 17 major offence categories is largely one of stable or falling crime; 10 were stable and seven were trending down.

However, **Gunnedah is one of eight Local Government Areas (LGAs) with upward trends for two of the 17 major offences.**

While crimes such as robbery without a weapon, motor vehicle theft, steal from motor vehicle, steal from person and malicious damage were among the offences trending downwards across the state, **eight Statistical Divisions (SDs), including North Western, showed upward trends in at least one offence**.

Stealing from a motor vehicle (up 2.2 per cent) and steal from retail store (up 13.7 per cent) puts this region in with Illawarra, Mid-North Coast, Northern, Central West, South Eastern and Murrumbidgee SDs."

NSW crime report - Gunnedah

Offence	Jan-Dec 2010	Rate per 100,000	24 month trend	60 month trend
Assault	70	575.6	stable	stable
Other assault	101	830	stable	stable
Sexual assault	13	106.9	nc	nc
Indecent assault	14	115.1	nc	nc
Robbery with a weapon	4	32.9	nc	nc
Break and enter dwelling	98	805.8	Stable	**11.7%**
Motor vehicle theft	32	263.1	Stable	nc
Steal from a motor vehicle	**139**	**1,142.9**	**44.8%**	**12.1%**
Steal from a retail store	30	246.7	Stable	nc
Steal from a dwelling	72	592.0	Stable	Stable
Fraud	25	205.6	Stable	**-12/7%**
Malicious damage to property	**286**	**2,351.6**	**24.9%**	**Stable**

“Crime figures put shire in spotlight”... continued
April 19, 2011 from *Namoi Valley Independent*

“What must have been alarming for the government is the statistics for drug-related offences.

Among the expanded list of 62 offences for the same 24-month period, 12 showed an upward trend. These included

possession and/or use of cocaine (up 23.3 per cent),

p/u of cannabis (up 36.9 per cent),

p/u amphetamines (up 54 per cent),

p/u of other drugs (up 42.3 per cent),

dealing, trafficking in cannabis (up 33.4 per cent),

d/t in amphetamines (up 63.2 per cent),

d/t in other drugs (up 50.6 per cent),

other drug offences (up 12.2 percent),

prostitution offences (up 56.3 per cent),

breach bail conditions (up 7.4 per cent),

fail to appear (up 20.1 per cent), and

transport regulatory offences (up 26.5 per cent).

Most of these offences are discovered by police rather than reported to them, according to the report.”

Drug crime – the facts for Gunnedah

Offence	Count	Rate per 100,000	24 month trend	60 month trend
P/U cocaine	0	0.0	nc	nc
P/U narcotics	1	8.2	nc	nc
P/U cannabis	75	616.7	stable	nc
P/U amphetamines	5	41.1	nc	nc
P/U ecstasy	0	0.0	nc	nc
P/U other drugs	3	24.7	nc	nc
Cultivating cannabis	4	32.9	nc	nc
Other drug offences	7	57.6	nc	nc

Issues Arising

- Complexity of the Australian criminal justice system
- High profile and misuse of criminal justice statistics
- Reluctance of data custodians to release data
- Lack of documentation about datasets
- Sustainability and continuity of NCJRDN beyond 2011

State of Play

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- Formal agreement in place between the UWA Crime Research Centre and UWA Information Services
- Have made a start on archiving and curating datasets
- Working within the broader ADA framework
- Portal / ADA sub-archive due later in 2011